and then goes online using the software, he is first connected to the central server. Once connected, he can then search for a specific song and sends his search on the server.

On the server side, it has indexed files that are available on other nodes connected to the server. Depending on the search you have sent, you will find a list of files or results. Now you can sort the results according to the bit rate, file size, artist name or any of the other factors important to you and get a more relevant file list.

Once you have chosen what file to download, the Napster software on the other end of the line will upload the file directly to them. The locations of all the music files of the users that are currently online are kept on the central network, but the files themselves stay on the users' computers until another computer asks for it.

The main advantage of a network such as Napster is the easy access provided to users for searching any music. Once connected, all you needed to do was send a search-and a specific one at that-to get whatever you want.

Another factor is that unlike Web search results that are not updated from time to time, results obtained from Napster are current and available. One click and the download is on! Moreover, downloads are multi-threaded, so all available parts from sources are to be downloaded first instead of a sequential download. This multi-threaded downloading principle is currently implemented in newer P2P software and even in software such as Mass Downloader and Flashget which let you make HTTP downloads faster.

In case of Napster, the system makes available a massive variety of music, because the users provide the files, not Napster. Napster just provides the software and network infrastructure, and users provide the content. This system inherently provides more benefit to the users the more popular it becomes. Popularity in this case is a direct result of improving content.